

Rohan Surve

Technical Subject Matter Expert

(Software Product, Architecture & Automation)

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WHY A TECHNICAL SME

Most investment teams can evaluate a market, a business model, and a founder!

Few can independently assess whether the technology actually holds up, whether the architecture will scale, whether the "AI-powered" claim is real, whether the engineering team can execute on the roadmap they have pitched.

That's the gap I fill.

WHAT I BRING

- *13+ years architecting, building, and scaling technical products, from writing production code to single-handedly architecting enterprise automation tools used by Google, Ferrari, and Lenovo*
- *I have sat on both sides of the table: as the person building the product, and as the person in the Founder's Office deciding what gets built next*
- *I evaluate technology the way an operator does: not just "is this technically sound," but "will this scale, will this team ship it, and is this defensible."*

DOMAIN DEPTH

- *Test Automation, RPA & DevTools: Deep, hands-on expertise, built and scaled products*
- *SaaS Architecture: On-prem to SaaS transitions, pay-as-you-use models*
- *AI-Augmented Products: Separating genuine ML/AI capability from marketing language*
- *Enterprise Software: SAP ecosystem, large enterprise client requirements (Google, Ferrari, Lenovo, Infosys, BMC, and more)*

TRACK RECORD (PROOF, NOT PROMISES)

- *Architected and single-handedly built a SAP GUI test automation tool: new revenue stream, edge over competition*
- *Architected an AI and ML based automation tool by identifying the gap in PLM and ECADD space for automotive vertical, resulting in 30% of total revenue*
- *Took release cycles from 2.5 years → 4 months → weekly, by fixing root-cause engineering and process gaps*
- *Solved technical problems other vendors couldn't: including authentication challenges that unlocked Google's Waymo as a client, solved performance plus reliability problem for Ferrari that led to onboard them*
- *Reduced customer-reported technical issues from 40/month to 2/month through root-cause fixes in the product, not patches*

WHERE I ADD VALUE IN DILIGENCE & PORTFOLIO SUPPORT

Technical Due Diligence

- *Architecture review: scalability, technical debt, security posture*
- *Validating AI/ML claims: is it real ML, a wrapper, or rules-based automation dressed up as AI*
- *Codebase and engineering process health checks*
- *Build vs buy vs partner assessments*

Product & Engineering Evaluation

- *Assessing product-market fit from a technical feasibility lens*
- *Reviewing release velocity, technical roadmap realism, and engineering team structure*
- *Evaluating automation, SaaS, and dev-tools products specifically has been my core domain*

Portfolio Company Support

- *Hands-on guidance for portfolio companies stuck on technical architecture decisions*
- *Helping technical founders translate vision into roadmaps (done this directly in a Founder's Office for 7+ years)*
- *Diagnosing why release cycles are slow, support costs are high, or churn is technical in nature; and fixing it*